

At M3M Foundation, our work across education, skills, livelihoods, health, sports, environment and rural development is guided by one fundamental principle: **development must create agency.**

In 2024–25, through programmes such as **Saakshar and iMpower**, we supported more than **20,000 children**, awarded over **1,000 scholarships**, and created more than **25 safe spaces for migrant children across five states**. These numbers matter, but what matters more is what lies behind them: a child who remains in education is a future member of India's skilled workforce; a girl who continues her education is more likely to exercise economic agency; a child who acquires digital literacy is better equipped to participate in an increasingly technology-driven economy.

Education is therefore not merely a social intervention. **It is economic infrastructure.**

Similarly, through **Kaushal Sambal, Mashaal and iMpower Academy**, more than **12,000 young people have been trained, with 68% being women and a 76% placement rate**, while more than **100 young innovators have been nurtured**.

These are not simply employment numbers.

They represent a shift in the architecture of aspiration. India cannot build the manufacturing capabilities of tomorrow with the skills of yesterday. Our young people must be equipped for an economy that will increasingly demand technological fluency, adaptability, entrepreneurship, problem-solving and the ability to learn continuously.

Our ambition, therefore, is not merely to make young people employable.

It is to make them future-ready.

And where possible, to make them employers, innovators and entrepreneurs.

The rural economy must become part of India's growth story

There is another dimension to India's manufacturing ambition that deserves considerably greater attention: **the transformation of rural India from a source of labour into a source of**



enterprise. For decades, development has often been understood as a movement of people from villages to cities. But India's future need not be defined by that binary.

We must increasingly ask: **what if opportunity could travel to the village?** Through our work under **Sankalp and Sarvodaya**, more than **300 farmers have been engaged, over 50 kitchen gardens have been developed**, and interventions have reached more than **200 villages**.

Our aspiration is to help transform the Annadata into an entrepreneur.

This means moving beyond the traditional agricultural model of producing raw commodities and accepting whatever price the market offers. It means building knowledge, skills, local value addition, sustainable farming practices, market access and entrepreneurial capability around agriculture. A farmer who can process, package, brand and market his produce is no longer merely a producer at the beginning of a value chain. He becomes a participant in it.

That distinction is fundamental to the India we envision for 2047.

If manufacturing is to become one of the great engines of India's growth, our rural communities must also become part of the manufacturing and value-addition ecosystem—through food processing, handicrafts, local enterprises, agri-processing, sustainable products and decentralised economic activity.

The village must not merely supply the workforce for India's cities; it must become a place where enterprise itself can flourish.

Women will be central to the India we manufacture

There can be no truly developed India without economically empowered women. The numbers emerging from our own interventions reinforce this conviction. Women constitute **68% of the young people trained through our skills ecosystem**, demonstrating that when opportunity is deliberately made accessible, women do not merely participate—they excel.

But empowerment cannot end with a certificate.

The real measure is whether a woman has an income, whether she can make financial decisions, whether she possesses a marketable skill, whether her family recognises her economic contribution and whether her daughter grows up believing that her own possibilities are limitless. That is why our approach increasingly seeks to connect **skills with livelihoods, livelihoods with entrepreneurship, and entrepreneurship with dignity and independence.**

The women who become financially capable today will raise children who are more likely to aspire tomorrow. In that sense, women's empowerment has a multiplier effect that extends far beyond the individual.

It is one of the most powerful investments India can make in its demographic future. That, to me, is the true meaning of **Viksit Bharat**.

And that is the responsibility we have inherited.

2047 is not just a destination. It is our Kartavya.